

بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ

IN THE NAME OF ALLAH, THE MOST MERCIFUL,
THE ESPECIALLY MERCIFUL



WHEN YOU STAND TO PRAY

BOOK 1:
THE JOURNEY INSIDE SALAT



PRAYER IS NOT SOMETHING YOU FINISH.
IT IS SOMETHING THAT TRANSFORMS YOU.

BY
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When You Stand to Pray

Book 1: The Journey Inside Salat

By

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This book is a reflective guide based on the Qur'an and authentic hadith. It is not intended to replace qualified scholarly guidance in matters of fiqh or formal legal rulings.

Introduction

This book is not written for scholars.

It is written for people.

For the one who prays every day but sometimes feels disconnected.

For the one who struggles to focus.

For the one who is learning.

For the one who wants more from prayer than routine.

Salat is something many of us already know.

We know the steps.

We know the words.

We know when it begins and when it ends.

But knowing the structure of prayer is not the same as feeling its meaning.

This book is about that meaning.

It is about slowing down, understanding what each part of the prayer carries, and allowing the heart to be present while the body moves.

It is not a book of detailed legal rulings.

It is a reflective guide grounded in the Qur'an and authentic hadith.

My hope is simple:

that when you finish this book, you do not only know prayer better - you feel it better.

And if even one prayer becomes more sincere, more present, and more personal because of these pages, then this book will have served its purpose.

How to Use This Book

You do not need to rush this book.

Read one chapter at a time.

Pause where something touches your heart.

Return to a chapter before prayer if you need to.

This book was written to be read slowly.

It is not only about learning what happens in salat.

It is about learning to notice it.

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CHAPTER 1

Intention (Niyyah)

There's something about prayer that most people don't notice.

It doesn't begin when you say Allahu Akbar.

It begins before that.

It begins in your heart.

Before you move your body...
before you raise your hands...
you've already made a decision.

"I'm about to stand in front of Allah."

That moment right there is your intention.

Intention isn't something you say.

It's not a sentence you whisper.
It's not something complicated.

It's simply knowing why you are about to pray.

And Allah already knows it.

He says:

"And they were not commanded except to worship Allah, being sincere to Him in religion..."
(Surah Al-Bayyinah 98:5)

Sincerity - that's what intention really is.

The Prophet (peace be upon him) said:

"Actions are judged by intentions, and every person will have what they intended."
(Sahih al-Bukhari and Sahih Muslim)

This hadith is powerful.

Because it means something simple but deep:

Two people can pray the same prayer.

Same movements.

Same words.

Same time.

But one of them is accepted...
and the other may not be.

Not because of how they prayed.

But because of why they prayed.

Sometimes we stand to pray, but our mind is somewhere else.

Thinking about:

Work

Money

Problems

Messages on our phone

We rush through it.

We finish it.

And we move on.

But was that really a meeting with Allah...
or just something we needed to get out of the way?

Intention changes everything.

It turns prayer from a habit...
into a connection.

From an obligation...
into something personal.

A lot of people overthink intention.

They ask:

“Do I have to say it out loud?”

“What if I didn’t do it properly?”

“What if I got it wrong?”

But Islam is simple.

If you got up to pray...

If you know which prayer you’re about to perform...

Then your intention is already there.

You don’t need to complicate what Allah made easy.

But here’s where we can do better.

Before you start your prayer - pause.

Just for a few seconds.

Don’t rush straight into it.

Let everything slow down.

And remind yourself:

“This prayer is for Allah.”

Not for routine.

Not because you feel forced.

Not just to tick a box.

For Allah.

That small pause...

can completely change your salat.

Because at the end of the day -

Salat is not just about movements.

It’s not just about standing, bowing, and prostrating.

It's about what your heart is doing while your body moves.

So ask yourself honestly:

When I pray...

Am I just completing something?

Or am I standing in front of my Creator?

That answer -

is where your intention begins.

CHAPTER 2

Purification (Wudu)

Before you stand in front of Allah...
you are asked to wash.

Not because Allah needs it.

But because you do.

Think about it.

Every day, we go through life picking things up.

Not just dirt...
but stress...
mistakes...
distractions...

By the time it's time to pray, we're carrying a lot.

Wudu is your reset.

Allah says:

"O you who believe, when you rise to pray, wash your faces and your hands up to the elbows, wipe over your heads, and wash your feet to the ankles..."
(Surah Al-Ma'idah 5:6)

This isn't just instruction.

It's preparation.

The Prophet (peace be upon him) said:

"Allah does not accept the prayer of one of you if he breaks his wudu until he performs wudu."
(Sahih al-Bukhari)

That shows how important this step is.

Before the prayer begins...
before you even say a word...
purification comes first.

But wudu is more than just washing.

It's not just:
rinse
wipe
done

There's something deeper happening.

The Prophet (peace be upon him) also said:

"When a Muslim washes his face, every sin he committed with his eyes is washed away... when he washes his hands, every sin they committed is washed away... until he comes out pure from sins."
(Sahih Muslim)

Think about that.

Every drop of water...
is taking something away.

When you wash your face...
you're not just cleaning your skin.

You're washing away what your eyes looked at.

When you wash your hands...
you're not just removing dirt.

You're washing away what your hands may have done.

When you wash your feet...
you're washing away where they took you.

Wudu is not just physical.

It's spiritual.

But here's the reality.

Most of us rush it.

We do it quickly.

We don't think.

We just want to "get to the prayer."

But wudu is part of the prayer.

If you rush your preparation...
you'll feel it in your salat.

Try this next time.

Slow it down.

Feel the water.

Be present.

And as you wash each part, think:

"Ya Allah, cleanse me."

Not just outside...
but inside too.

Because by the time you finish wudu...
you're not the same person you were a minute ago.

You're cleaner.

Lighter.

More ready.

Now you're prepared.

Not just to pray...
but to stand in front of Allah.

CHAPTER 3

The Call to Prayer (Adhan)

There's a moment that happens five times a day.

A moment many people hear...
but few really listen to.

The Adhan is not just a notification.

It's not just background sound.

It's a call.

A call from Allah.

Think about the words:

Allahu Akbar, Allahu Akbar

Allah is Greater... Allah is Greater.

Greater than what?

Greater than whatever you're doing.

Greater than whatever is on your mind.

Greater than anything pulling your attention away.

Then comes the reminder:

Ashhadu an la ilaha illa Allah

I bear witness that there is no god but Allah.

Ashhadu anna Muhammadur Rasulullah

I bear witness that Muhammad is the Messenger of
Allah.

This is not just information.

It's a reset.

A reminder of who you are...
and why you're here.

Then comes the invitation:

Hayya 'ala as-salah
Come to prayer.

Hayya 'ala al-falah
Come to success.

Notice something powerful.

Allah didn't say:

"Come to burden."
"Come to obligation."

He said:

Come to success.

The Prophet (peace be upon him) said:

"If the people knew the reward of the Adhan and the first row, and they could not get it except by drawing lots, they would draw lots."
(Sahih al-Bukhari)

That's how valuable this moment is.

But let's be honest.

How many times have we heard the Adhan...
and kept doing what we were doing?

"Just one more minute..."
"Let me finish this..."
"I'll pray later..."

And later turns into delay.
And delay turns into rushing.
And rushing turns into emptiness.

The Adhan is not just calling you to pray.

It's calling you to pause your life.

To step away from everything...
and turn back to Allah.

There's also something beautiful the Prophet (peace be upon him) taught us.

When you hear the Adhan...
don't ignore it.

Respond to it.

Repeat what the Mu'adhin says.

The Prophet (peace be upon him) said:

"When you hear the caller to prayer, say what he says..."

(Sahih Muslim)

This turns the Adhan into a conversation.

Not just something you hear...
but something you engage with.

Next time you hear it - try this.

Stop.

Even if it's just for a moment.

Listen properly.

Repeat the words.

Let them sink in.

Because one day...
there will be a call you cannot respond to.

But today - you still can.

So when you hear:

Hayya 'ala as-salah...

Ask yourself:

Am I going to answer?

Because the Adhan is not just a sound. It's an invitation.

And every time it's called...
you are being invited by Allah.

CHAPTER 4

Facing the Qiblah

When you stand to pray...
you don't face just any direction.

You turn your body.
You align yourself.
You face one point.

No matter where you are in the world -

Australia...
Africa...
America...

Every Muslim turns toward the same place:

The Ka'bah in Makkah.

But this isn't just about direction.

It's about unity.

Allah says:

*"So turn your face toward al-Masjid al-Haram. And
wherever you are, turn your faces toward it..."*
(Surah Al-Baqarah 2:144)

This command connects every believer.

Different languages.
Different cultures.
Different lives.

But when it's time to pray -
everyone stands in one direction.

Think about that.

Millions of people...
at the same time...
all turning toward one point.

Not because of habit.

But because Allah told them to.

Facing the Qiblah is a physical act.

But it carries a deeper meaning.

In life, we get pulled in different directions.

Work pulls you one way.

Stress pulls you another.

Desires pull you somewhere else.

Everything competes for your attention.

But in prayer -
you stop.

You choose one direction.

And you commit to it.

That's what the Qiblah teaches you.

Focus.

Clarity.

Purpose.

It's not just your body turning.

It's your heart aligning.

There's also something powerful in this:

You are not alone.

At the exact moment you're praying -
there are people all over the world:

Standing like you
Bowing like you
Prostrating like you
Facing the same direction.
Worshipping the same Lord.

You may feel alone in your life sometimes.

But in salat -
you are part of something much bigger.

And even if you're praying by yourself...
you are still connected.

So next time you stand to pray -
don't just quickly face the Qiblah.

Pause for a second.

Realize what you're doing.

You are aligning yourself with millions of believers...
and turning toward a place chosen by Allah.

Because at the end of the day -
the Qiblah is not just about where you face.

It's about what you choose to face in life.

So ask yourself:

Am I just turning my body...
or am I also turning my heart?

CHAPTER 5

The Opening Takbir (Allahu Akbar)

There's a moment in prayer where everything changes.

It's the moment you raise your hands...
and say:

Allahu Akbar.

It may seem simple.

Just two words.

But those two words draw a line between two worlds.

Before that moment -
you're in your life.

Thinking.

Moving.

Busy.

After that moment -
you are in salat.

Standing before Allah.

The Prophet (peace be upon him) said:

"The key to prayer is purification... its beginning is the Takbir..."

(Sunan Abu Dawood - authentic)

This means something important:

Without Takbir...
you haven't truly entered the prayer.

But what does Allahu Akbar really mean?

It doesn't just mean:

"Allah is great."

It means:

Allah is greater.

Greater than what?

Greater than everything.

Greater than your worries

Greater than your stress

Greater than your problems

Greater than whatever is on your mind

So when you say Allahu Akbar -

you are making a statement.

You are saying:

"Ya Allah... right now, You are more important than anything else."

But here's the reality.

Many of us say it...

without thinking about it.

We raise our hands.

We say the words.

We move on.

But imagine if you truly felt it.

Imagine saying Allahu Akbar...

and actually leaving everything behind.

That message you were thinking about...

that problem stressing you...

that distraction pulling you...
you put it all aside.

Because now -
you are standing before Allah.

There's also something powerful in the movement.

When you raise your hands -
it's like you're letting go.

Letting go of the dunya behind you.
And stepping into something greater.

This is your entrance.
Your transition.

Your moment to disconnect from everything else...
and connect with Allah.

So next time you start your prayer -
don't rush it.

Pause for a second.
Raise your hands slowly.

And when you say:

Allahu Akbar

mean it.

Because if you enter your prayer properly...
the rest of your salat will feel different.

Ask yourself:

When I say Allahu Akbar...

Do I really believe that Allah is greater than everything
on my mind?

Because that moment -
is where your prayer truly begins.

CHAPTER 6

Standing (Qiyam)

After you say Allahu Akbar...
you don't move straight away.

You stand.

Still.

Quiet.

It might not seem like much.

But this moment is powerful.

Because now -
you are standing before Allah.

Not sitting.

Not distracted.

Not busy.

Standing.

Focused.

Present.

Allah says:

*"And stand before Allah with devotion."
(Surah Al-Baqarah 2:238)*

This is not just about posture.

It's about presence.

Think about it.

If you were standing in front of someone important...
a judge...
a leader...

you wouldn't be careless.

You wouldn't be looking around.

You wouldn't be distracted.

Now ask yourself:

How do I stand in front of Allah?

Qiyam is a moment of awareness.

A moment where you realise:

"Allah is watching me right now."

The Prophet (peace be upon him) described excellence in worship in a powerful way.

He said:

"Worship Allah as if you see Him, and if you cannot see Him, know that He sees you."

(Sahih Muslim)

This is what Qiyam is about.

You stand there...

not just with your body -

but with your heart aware.

But let's be real.

Sometimes we stand in prayer...

and our mind is everywhere else.

Thinking about:

What we need to do next

Conversations

Problems

Plans

Our body is in prayer...
but our mind is not.

And that's the struggle.

Qiyam is your chance to bring it back.

To slow everything down.

To remind yourself:

"Right now... nothing else matters."

You don't have to be perfect.

You don't have to block every thought.

But you can try.

You can return.
Again and again.

Even if your mind drifts -
bring it back.

Gently.
Without frustration.

Because every time you come back...
you're choosing Allah again.

There's also something humbling about standing.

You are not leaning.
You are not relaxed.

You are upright.

Like someone ready to meet their Lord.

So next time you stand in prayer -
don't rush through it.

Feel it.

Be aware.

Let your heart catch up with your body.

Because Qiyam is not just standing.

It's being present while standing.

Ask yourself:

When I stand in prayer...

Am I just there physically?

Or am I truly present before Allah?

Because that moment -

sets the tone for everything that follows.

CHAPTER 7

Recitation (Surah Al-Fatiha)

After you stand...
you begin to speak.

Not to yourself.
Not to the room.

But to Allah.

And the words you begin with are not random.

They are the most important words in your prayer:

Surah Al-Fatiha.

This surah is recited in every single unit of prayer.

Every rak'ah.
Every day.
Again and again.

Why?

Because this is not just recitation.

This is a conversation.

The Prophet (peace be upon him) narrated that Allah says:

"I have divided the prayer between Myself and My servant into two halves..."

(Sahih Muslim)

And then with every verse of Al-Fatiha -
Allah responds.

When you say:

"Alhamdulillah Rabbil 'alamin"
(All praise is for Allah, Lord of all worlds)

Allah says:

"My servant has praised Me."

When you say:

"Ar-Rahman ir-Raheem"
(The Most Merciful, the Most Compassionate)

Allah says:

"My servant has extolled Me."

When you say:

"Maliki yawmid-deen"
(Master of the Day of Judgment)

Allah says:

"My servant has glorified Me."

Then comes the moment that changes everything:

"Iyyaka na'budu wa iyyaka nasta'een"
(You alone we worship, and You alone we ask for help)

Allah says:

"This is between Me and My servant..."

And then you ask:

"Ihdinas-siratal mustaqeem..."
(Guide us to the straight path)

And Allah says:

"This is for My servant - and My servant will have what he asked for."

Think about that.

Every time you recite Al-Fatiha...
Allah is responding to you.

But how often do we feel that?

Sometimes we recite quickly.
Without thinking.
Without understanding.

Just trying to get through it.

But imagine slowing down.

Understanding what you're saying.
Feeling every word.

You are praising Allah.
You are declaring your worship.
You are asking for guidance.

And Allah is responding to you.

This is not just recitation.

This is a direct connection.

If you ever feel distant in your prayer -
start here.

With Al-Fatiha.

Take your time.
Pause between the verses.
Let the words sink in.

Because this surah is not just something you read.

It's something you live.

You are saying:

"You alone we worship."

But do we really mean it?

You are asking:

"Guide us."

But are we truly seeking guidance?

Al-Fatiha is a mirror.

It shows you where your heart is.

So next time you recite it -
don't rush.

Don't just say the words.

Feel them.

Understand them.

Let them reach your heart.

Because in that moment -
you are not just reciting.

You are speaking...
and Allah is responding.

CHAPTER 8

Additional Recitation (Qur'an after Al-Fatiha)

After you finish Al-Fatiha...
you don't stay silent.

You continue.

You recite more of the Qur'an.

This part of the prayer is often overlooked.

People focus on movements...
on getting things "right"...
but forget this moment.

Because this is where you listen to Allah.

Allah says:

*"So recite what is easy from the Qur'an."
(Surah Al-Muzzammil 73:20)*

Simple.

Clear.

You don't need long surahs.

You don't need perfection.

You just need sincerity.

After Al-Fatiha -
you choose something from the Qur'an.

Maybe a short surah you memorised as a child.

Maybe something you recently learned.

Maybe something small.

And that's enough.

But here's the deeper question:

Do we understand what we're saying?

Sometimes we recite on autopilot.

The words come out...
but the heart is not there.

We've memorised the sounds -
but not the meaning.

And because of that -
we miss the impact.

The Qur'an is not just meant to be recited.

It's meant to be felt.

When you recite:

Do you know what you're saying?
Do you reflect on it?
Do you let it affect you?

Because these are not just words.

These are the words of Allah.

Imagine this.

You are standing in front of your Creator...
and you are reciting His words back to Him.

That's something powerful.

Even if you only know short surahs -
take your time with them.

Repeat them.
Understand them.
Let them sink in.

You don't need a lot.

You just need presence.

And if you're learning -
that's even better.

Every new verse you learn...
brings something new into your prayer.

The Prophet (peace be upon him) said:

*"The best of you are those who learn the Qur'an and
teach it."*

(Sahih al-Bukhari)

So every step you take -
even small -
matters.

Here's something practical you can do.

Pick one short surah.
Learn its meaning.

Even if it takes a few days.

Then when you recite it in prayer -
you'll feel something different.

Because now -
you're not just repeating.

You're understanding.

And that changes everything.

So next time you reach this part of your prayer -
don't rush it.

Don't treat it like a filler.

This is your moment...
to connect with the words of Allah.

Ask yourself:

Am I just reciting what I memorised...
or am I actually listening to what Allah is saying?

Because the Qur'an was not revealed...
just to be read.

It was revealed...
to change hearts.

CHAPTER 9

Bowing (Ruku)

After you stand...
after you recite...
you bend.

You lower your body.
You bow.

This is Ruku.

It's a simple movement.

But it carries a deep meaning.

Allah says:

*"O you who believe! Bow and prostrate and worship
your Lord..."*
(Surah Al-Hajj 22:77)

Ruku is the first moment in your prayer where you
physically lower yourself.

You're no longer standing tall.
You're no longer upright.
You are bowing.

And that position says something without words.

It says:

"Ya Allah... I humble myself before You."

In Ruku, your back is straight.
Your head is level.
You are balanced.
Still.

And your tongue says:

"Subhana Rabbiyal 'Adheem"
(Glory be to my Lord, the Most Great)

Notice the words.

You are declaring Allah's greatness...
while lowering yourself.

That's the essence of Ruku.

The more you recognize His greatness...
the more you naturally humble yourself.

But let's be honest.

Sometimes we rush this part.

We dip down quickly...
say the words fast...
and come straight back up.

But Ruku is not meant to be rushed.

It's meant to be felt.

The Prophet (peace be upon him) used to remain in Ruku
calmly, not rushing through it.
(Reported in Sahih al-Bukhari)

Because this is a moment of humility.
A moment of stillness.
A moment of recognition.

Think about it.

In your daily life -
how often do you humble yourself?

Truly humble yourself?

We like to feel in control.
We like to feel strong.

We like to feel above things.

But in Ruku -
you let that go.

You choose to lower yourself.

Not because you are weak.

But because Allah is greater.

Here's something practical.

Next time you go into Ruku -
pause.

Don't rush.
Let your body settle.

And when you say:

"Subhana Rabbiyal 'Adheem"

mean it.

Think about what you're saying.

Because you are not just repeating words.

You are acknowledging:

"My Lord is Most Great... greater than everything."

And when that understanding enters your heart -
humility becomes natural.

So ask yourself:

When I bow...

Am I just performing a movement?

Or am I truly humbling myself before Allah?

Because Ruku is not just about bending your back.

It's about softening your heart.

CHAPTER 10

Standing After Ruku

After you bow...
you rise.

Slowly.
Calmly.

You stand again.

But this is not the same standing as before.

Something has changed.

You've just humbled yourself.
You've just lowered your body.

And now - you come back up.

As you rise, you say:

"Sami'a Allahu liman hamidah"
(Allah hears the one who praises Him)

Then you stand and say:

"Rabbana wa lakal hamd"
(Our Lord, and to You belongs all praise)

This moment may feel small.

But it carries something powerful.

You are being told:

Allah hears you.

The Prophet (peace be upon him) used to say:

"Allah hears the one who praises Him..."
(Sahih al-Bukhari)

Think about that.

Out of everything in your life...
all the noise...
all the voices...

Allah hears you.

And not just hears you -
He responds.

So when you say:

"Rabbana wa lakal hamd"

don't just say it.
Feel it.

You are praising Allah -
after you just humbled yourself.

It's like a cycle:

You lower yourself in Ruku...
and then you rise with gratitude.

This teaches something important.

Humility should lead to praise.

When you recognise who Allah is...
you can't help but thank Him.

But again -
this is a moment we often rush.

We come up quickly...
say the words fast...
and move straight into sujood.

But this pause matters.

The Prophet (peace be upon him) would stand calmly in this position.

He didn't rush through it.

(Sahih al-Bukhari)

Because this is your moment to acknowledge something:

Allah heard me.

And if Allah hears you...

then your words matter.

Your praise matters.

Your prayer matters.

Here's something practical.

Next time you rise from Ruku -
don't rush into the next movement.

Stand still for a moment.

Let your body settle.

And when you say:

"Rabbana wa lakal hamd"

say it with awareness.

Think about your life.

Think about what Allah has given you.

Even the things you take for granted.

Because gratitude is not just words.

It's awareness.

So ask yourself:

When I stand after Ruku...

Do I realise that Allah just heard me?

Because this moment -
is not just a transition.

It's a reminder.

A reminder that you are seen.

You are heard.

And you are not alone.

CHAPTER 11

Prostration (Sujood)

After you stand...
you don't stay upright.

You go down.
All the way down.

Your forehead touches the ground.
Your nose.
Your hands.
Your knees.
Your feet.

Everything lowers.

This is Sujood.

And this is the closest you will ever be to Allah in your prayer.

The Prophet (peace be upon him) said:

"The closest a servant is to his Lord is when he is in prostration..."
(Sahih Muslim)

Think about that.

You are at your lowest position physically...
but at your highest position spiritually.

Nothing else in your life looks like this.

In the world -
people try to rise.

To be seen.
To be elevated.

To be above others.

But in Islam -
you go down to rise.

You place your face - the most honoured part of your
body -
on the ground.

Why?

Because in that moment, you are saying:

“Ya Allah... I submit completely to You.”

And what do you say in sujood?

*“Subhana Rabbiyal A‘la”
(Glory be to my Lord, the Most High)*

Notice the contrast.

You are the lowest...
and you are calling Allah the Most High.

That is the essence of sujood.

But here’s something many people miss.

Sujood is not just for recitation.

It’s also a moment to ask.

The Prophet (peace be upon him) said:

*“...so increase your supplication in it.”
(Sahih Muslim)*

This is your moment.
Your private moment.

No one sees you.
No one hears you.

But Allah does.

Whatever is in your heart -
this is where you bring it out.

Your worries.
Your struggles.
Your fears.
Your hopes.

Say it.
Ask.
Be real.

You don't need perfect words.
You don't need long du'as.

Just speak to Allah.

But again -
we rush it.

We go down...
say the words quickly...
and come back up.

And we miss the most powerful part of the prayer.

Imagine this.

You are closest to Allah...
and you barely stay there.

Slow it down.
Stay a little longer.

Feel the ground.
Feel the stillness.

And when you say:

"Subhana Rabbiyal A'la"

mean it.

Because in that moment -
nothing else matters.

It's just you...
and Allah.

So ask yourself:

When I go into sujood...
Do I just touch the ground?
Or do I truly submit?

Because sujood is not just a position.

It's a state.

A state of humility.
A state of closeness.
A state of surrender.

And the more you feel that -
the more your prayer will change.

CHAPTER 12

Sitting Between the Two Sujood

After you go down into sujood...
you don't stay there.

You rise.

But not fully.

You sit.

This moment is often quick.
Sometimes rushed.
Sometimes barely noticed.

But it shouldn't be.

Because between the two sujood...
you are given a moment to ask.

The Prophet (peace be upon him) would say in this position:

"Rabbi ighfir li, Rabbi ighfir li"
(My Lord, forgive me, my Lord, forgive me)
(Sunan Abu Dawood - authentic)

Think about that.

After being closest to Allah in sujood...
the first thing you do when you rise -
is ask for forgiveness.

Why?

Because no matter how much we worship...
we know we fall short.

This sitting is a moment of humility.
A moment of honesty.

You are not standing strong.
You are not moving.
You are sitting quietly.

And you're saying:

"Ya Allah... forgive me."

That's powerful.

But again -
this is a moment many of us rush.

We go up...
say it quickly...
and go back down.

But what if you slowed it down?

What if you actually felt the words?

Because forgiveness is something we all need.

Every day.
Every prayer.

Not just for big mistakes.
But for the small ones too.

The ones we forget.
The ones we don't even notice.

This moment is your chance.
To pause.
To reset.

Between two moments of closeness (sujood)...
you sit and ask.

It's like a breath.

A reset.

A reminder.

And you don't have to limit yourself.

You can say more.

You can ask for anything.

But even if all you say is:

"Rabbi ighfir li..."

Say it like you mean it.

Because Allah loves to forgive.

And He loves when His servant asks.

So next time you reach this part of your prayer -
don't rush it.

Sit properly.

Be still.

And ask.

Ask with sincerity.

Ask with need.

Ask with hope.

Because this moment -
is not just a pause.

It's an opportunity.

So ask yourself:

When I sit between the two sujood...

Am I just moving through it?

Or am I truly asking Allah to forgive me?

Because forgiveness -
might be the very thing your heart needs the most.

CHAPTER 13

Tashahhud (Sitting and Testifying Faith)

After cycles of standing...
bowing...
and prostrating...
you sit again.

But this time - it's different.

This is not just a pause.

This is a moment of declaration.

You sit calmly.
You settle.

And then you begin to say words that carry your entire belief.

"At-tahiyyatu lillahi was-salawatu wat-tayyibat..."
(All greetings, prayers, and pure words are for Allah...)

These are not just phrases.

These are words the Prophet (peace be upon him) taught his companions.

He said:

"When one of you sits in prayer, let him say..."
(Sahih al-Bukhari)

This moment connects you directly to the message of Islam.

You continue:

"Ashhadu an la ilaha illa Allah..."

(I bear witness that there is no god but Allah)

"Wa ashhadu anna Muhammadan 'abduhu wa rasuluh"

(And I bear witness that Muhammad is His servant and Messenger)

Think about that.

In the middle of your prayer -
you are renewing your faith.

Not once in your life.
Not just when you became Muslim.

But every single day.
Multiple times.

You are reminding yourself:

"This is what I believe."

And that matters.

Because life can distract you.
Pull you away.
Make you forget.

But in this moment -
you come back.

You sit quietly...
and you declare your belief again.

There's also something deeply personal about this.

You are not saying it in a crowd.
You are not saying it to people.

You are saying it in your prayer.
In front of Allah.

That gives it weight.
That gives it meaning.

But again -
many of us rush through it.

We memorised it long ago.
We say it quickly.
Without thinking.

But imagine slowing down.
Understanding each word.
Feeling what you're saying.

You are not just reciting.

You are affirming your identity.

And in that moment -
your prayer becomes more than movements.

It becomes belief in action.

So next time you reach Tashahhud -
sit properly.

Be still.

Take your time.

And when you say:

"Ashhadu an la ilaha illa Allah..."

feel it.

Because these are not just words.

They are the foundation of your life.

So ask yourself:

When I say the shahadah in my prayer...
Am I just repeating it?

Or am I truly believing it?

Because that moment -
is a reminder of who you are.
And who you belong to.

CHAPTER 14

Sending Peace Upon the Prophet (peace be upon him) (Salawat)

After you declare your faith...
you don't stop there.

You send peace.

Not to yourself.
Not to the people around you.

But to the one who brought you this prayer in the first place.

The Prophet Muhammad (peace be upon him).

In your prayer, you say:

"Allahumma salli 'ala Muhammad..."
(O Allah, send blessings upon Muhammad...)

This moment is not just tradition.

It's commanded.

Allah says:

"Indeed, Allah and His angels send blessings upon the Prophet. O you who believe, send blessings and peace upon him."
(Surah Al-Ahzab 33:56)

Think about that.

Allah Himself sends blessings upon the Prophet (peace be upon him).

The angels do too.

And you are being asked to do the same.

So when you say:

“Allahumma salli ‘ala Muhammad...”

you are joining something great.

Something ongoing.

Something honoured.

The Prophet (peace be upon him) also said:

“Whoever sends blessings upon me once, Allah sends blessings upon him ten times.”

(Sahih Muslim)

That means something incredible.

Every time you send peace upon the Prophet (peace be upon him)...

Allah sends peace and mercy upon you.

This is a gift.

Inside your prayer.

But there's something deeper here.

Without the Prophet (peace be upon him) -
you wouldn't know how to pray.

You wouldn't know these words.

You wouldn't know this connection.

He taught everything.

Step by step.

With patience.

With care.

So when you send peace upon him -
you are showing gratitude.

Gratitude for guidance.
Gratitude for Islam.
Gratitude for the path you're on.

But again -
this is something many of us rush.

We say it quickly.
We don't think about it.

But imagine saying it with awareness.

You are mentioning his name.
You are asking Allah to honour him.

And in return -
Allah honours you.

That changes how you feel.

So next time you reach this part of your prayer -
slow it down.

Say it properly.
Be present.

And remember:

You are not just reciting.

You are connecting yourself...
to the Messenger of Allah (peace be upon him).

So ask yourself:

When I send peace upon the Prophet (peace be upon him)...

Do I feel that connection?

Because this moment -
is a reminder of who showed you the way.

CHAPTER 15

Ending the Prayer (Tasleem)

After all the standing...
the bowing...
the prostrating...

After the words...
the reflection...
the connection...

You end your prayer with something simple.

You turn your head to the right and say:

"As-salamu 'alaykum wa rahmatullah"
(Peace and mercy of Allah be upon you)

Then to the left:

"As-salamu 'alaykum wa rahmatullah"

That's it.

That's how you leave the prayer.

The Prophet (peace be upon him) would end his prayer
this way.
(Sahih Muslim)

But think about the words you're using.

Peace.

After standing before Allah...
after humbling yourself...
after asking for forgiveness...
after reconnecting...

You leave with peace.

Not stress.
Not heaviness.
Not distraction.

Peace.

It's like you entered the prayer carrying the weight of
your life...
and you leave lighter.

The Tasleem is your return.

You step out of that private moment with Allah...
back into the world.

But ideally -
you don't return the same.

Because something should have changed.

Even if it's small.

Maybe your heart feels softer.
Maybe your mind feels clearer.
Maybe your worries feel lighter.

That's the impact of salat.

And the Tasleem seals it.

There's also something beautiful here.

You are spreading peace.
Even if no one is physically there.

Because Islam is built on peace.
And your prayer ends with it.

But again -
many of us rush this moment.

We finish quickly...
move straight on...
and forget what we just experienced.

But what if you paused?

Just for a second after Tasleem.

Let the moment settle.
Let the peace sink in.

Because this is the end of your meeting with Allah.

So ask yourself:

When I finish my prayer...
Do I carry that peace with me?
Or do I leave it behind?

Because the goal of salat...
is not just to pray.

It's to change you.

And if your prayer is real -
it won't just stay on the prayer mat.

It will follow you into your life.

Final Reflection

Before you close this book, pause for a moment and ask yourself:

Has my prayer changed?

Not only in how it looks -
but in how it feels.

Do I step into prayer with more awareness?

Do I stand with more sincerity?

Do I bow with more humility?

Do I prostrate with more closeness?

Salat was never meant to be a set of empty movements.
It was meant to bring you back -
again and again -
to your Lord.

Back to your purpose.

Back to your peace.

Back to what matters most.

If this book helps you slow down even once before
prayer,
if it helps you understand even one moment more
deeply,
if it helps you stand before Allah with a softer heart,
then let that be the beginning.

Because one sincere prayer can change a life.

About This Book

There is something about prayer that many people miss.

Not because it is complicated,
but because it has become familiar.

When something becomes familiar, it can also become
rushed.

And when it becomes rushed, it can lose the depth it was
meant to carry.

This book is not about teaching the outer steps of salat
alone.

It is about uncovering the meaning inside them.

From intention to tasleem, these pages take the reader
through the inner journey of prayer:

one moment, one movement, and one reflection at a
time.

Simple.

Reflective.

Grounded in the Qur'an and authentic hadith.

For new Muslims, lifelong Muslims, men, women, young,
and old -

this is an invitation to experience prayer with a more
present heart.